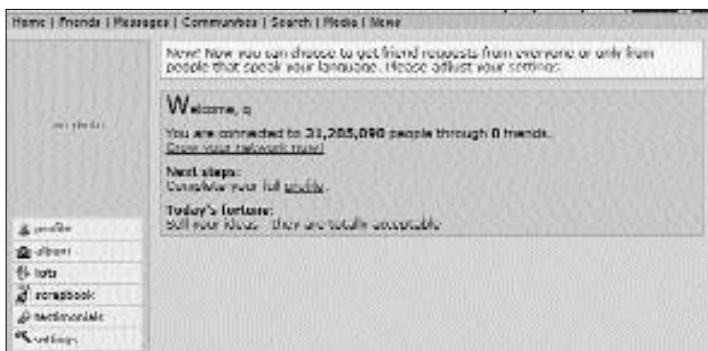


are modes of communication that allow the creation of relationships. To this combination, Orkut adds the system of relationship ranking, wherein acquaintances offer opinions about each other. These rankings act as an indicator to a newcomer about the possible outcome of an introduction.

9.3 Using Orkut

9.3.1 Creating a Profile



The Orkut welcome message

After the first sign-up, you need to fill up a profile page that seeks out as much information as possible. While only the first profile page is compulsory, filling up all four pages is recommended. This profile will be publicly viewable, so any person wanting to befriend you need not send an e-mail asking you for details if that question is already answered by your profile page. This also saves you the awkwardness of rejecting someone's offer of friendship. After providing these details, you are presented with an odd Welcome message like: "You are connected to 31,274,260 people through 0 friends. Grow your network now!"

Well, if one is already connected to all these people, do you really have to "grow your network"? A rare slip from Google. Expect that message to change very soon!